



HM Revenue
& Customs

Guidance

Rates and allowances: National Insurance contributions

Updated 6 April 2026

Contents

1. Class 1 National Insurance thresholds
2. Class 1 National Insurance rates
3. Class 2 and Class 4 National Insurance (self-employed)
4. Class 3 National Insurance (voluntary)
5. Historical and future rates
6. Income Tax rates



© Crown copyright 2026

This publication is licensed under the terms of the Open Government Licence v3.0 except where otherwise stated. To view this licence, visit nationalarchives.gov.uk/doc/open-government-licence/version/3 or write to the Information Policy Team, The National Archives, Kew, London TW9 4DU, or email: psi@nationalarchives.gov.uk.

Where we have identified any third party copyright information you will need to obtain permission from the copyright holders concerned.

This publication is available at <https://www.gov.uk/government/publications/rates-and-allowances-national-insurance-contributions/rates-and-allowances-national-insurance-contributions>

There are different ‘classes’ of National Insurance (NI) (<https://www.gov.uk/national-insurance/national-insurance-classes>). The type people pay depends on their employment status and how much they earn.

New National Insurance bands and allowances are usually announced in the Chancellor of the Exchequer’s Budget or Autumn Statement.

1. Class 1 National Insurance thresholds

Employers and employees pay Class 1 National Insurance depending on how much the employee earns. You can view these earnings thresholds by week (table 1.1) or by month (table 1.2).

1.1 Weekly thresholds

£ per week	2026 to 2027	2025 to 2026	2024 to 2025	2023 to 2024	6 July 2022 to 5 April 2023
Lower Earnings Limit (LEL) Employees do not pay National Insurance but get the <u>benefits of paying</u>	£129	£125	£123	£123	£123
Primary Threshold (PT) Employees start paying National Insurance	£242	£242	£242	£242	£242
Secondary Threshold (ST) Employers start paying National Insurance	£96	£96	£175	£175	£175

£ per week	2026 to 2027	2025 to 2026	2024 to 2025	2023 to 2024	6 July 2022 to 5 April 2023
Upper Earnings Limit (UEL) All employees pay a lower rate of National Insurance above this point	£967	£967	£967	£967	£967
Upper Secondary Threshold (UST) Employers of employees who are under 21 pay zero rate up to this point	£967	£967	£967	£967	£967
Apprentice Upper Secondary Threshold (AUST) Employers of certain apprentices who are under 25 pay zero rate up to this point	£967	£967	£967	£967	£967
Freeports Upper Secondary Threshold (FUST) Employers of eligible employees working in a freeport special tax site pay zero rate up to this point	£481	£481	£481	£481	£481
Investment Zones Upper Secondary Threshold (IZUST) Employers of eligible employees working in an investment zone special tax site pay zero rate up to this point	£481	£481	£481	Not applicable	Not applicable

£ per week	2026 to 2027	2025 to 2026	2024 to 2025	2023 to 2024	6 July 2022 to 5 April 2023
Veterans Upper Secondary Threshold (VUST) Employers of qualifying employees pay zero rate up to this point	£967	£967	£967	£967	£967

1.2 Monthly thresholds

£ per month	2026 to 2027	2025 to 2026	2024 to 2025	2023 to 2024	6 July 2022 to 5 April 2023
Lower Earnings Limit (LEL) Employees do not pay National Insurance but get the <u>benefits of paying</u>	£559	£542	£533	£533	£533
Primary Threshold (PT) Employees start paying National Insurance	£1,048	£1,048	£1,048	£1,048	£1,048
Secondary Threshold (ST) Employers start paying National Insurance	£417	£417	£758	£758	£758
Upper Earnings Limit (UEL) All employees pay a lower rate of	£4,189	£4,189	£4,189	£4,189	£4,189

£ per month	2026 to 2027	2025 to 2026	2024 to 2025	2023 to 2024	6 July 2022 to 5 April 2023
National Insurance above this point					
Upper Secondary Threshold (UST) Employers of employees who are under 21 pay zero rate up to this point	£4,189	£4,189	£4,189	£4,189	£4,189
Apprentice Upper Secondary Threshold (AUST) Employers of certain apprentices who are under 25 pay zero rate up to this point	£4,189	£4,189	£4,189	£4,189	£4,189
Freeports Upper Secondary Threshold (FUST) Employers of eligible employees working in a freeport special tax site pay zero rate up to this point	£2,083	£2,083	£2,083	£2,083	£2,083
Investment Zones Upper Secondary Threshold (IZUST) Employers of eligible employees working in an investment zone special tax site pay zero rate up to this point	£2,083	£2,083	£2,083	Not applicable	Not applicable
Veterans Upper Secondary Threshold (VUST)	£4,189	£4,189	£4,189	£4,189	£4,189

£ per month	2026 to 2027	2025 to 2026	2024 to 2025	2023 to 2024	6 July 2022 to 5 April 2023
Employers of qualifying employees pay zero rate up to this point					

2. Class 1 National Insurance rates

2.1 Employer rates

This table shows how much employers pay towards their employees' National Insurance.

Percentage rate	2026 to 2027	2025 to 2026	2024 to 2025	2023 to 2024	From 6 November 2022 to 5 April 2023
Rate above the Secondary Threshold	15%	15%	13.8%	13.8%	13.8%
Rate below Upper Secondary Threshold	0%	0%	0%	0%	0%
Rate below Freeports Upper Secondary Threshold	0%	0%	0%	0%	0%
Rate below Apprentice Upper Secondary Threshold	0%	0%	0%	0%	0%

Percentage rate	2026 to 2027	2025 to 2026	2024 to 2025	2023 to 2024	From 6 November 2022 to 5 April 2023
Rate below Investment Zones Upper Secondary Threshold	0%	0%	0%	Not applicable	Not applicable
Rate below Veterans Upper Secondary Threshold	0%	0%	0%	0%	0%
Class 1A rate on <u>expenses and benefits</u>	15%	15%	13.8%	13.8%	14.53%

The rate shown in the fourth column of the table (from 6 November 2022) is the Class 1A rate that applies to the whole tax year because Class 1A is an annualised charge.

Read CWG5 for the rates that apply to termination awards and sporting testimonials paid through real time information (<https://www.gov.uk/government/publications/cwg5-class-1a-national-insurance-contributions-on-benefits-in-kind>).

2.2 Employee rates

This table shows how much employers deduct from employees' pay.

Percentage rate	2026 to 2027	2025 to 2026	2024 to 2025	From 6 January 2024 to 5 April 2024	From 6 April 2023 to 5 January 2024	From 6 November 2022 to 5 April 2023
Between Primary	8%	8%	8%	10%	12%	12%

Percentage rate	2026 to 2027	2025 to 2026	2024 to 2025	From 6 January 2024 to 5 April 2024	From 6 April 2023 to 5 January 2024	From 6 November 2022 to 5 April 2023
Threshold and Upper Earnings Limit						
Above Upper Earnings Limit	2%	2%	2%	2%	2%	2%
<u>Married women's reduced rate</u> between primary threshold and upper earnings limit	1.85%	1.85%	1.85%	3.85%	5.85%	5.85%
<u>Rate for employees deferring National Insurance</u>	2%	2%	2%	2%	2%	2%

For 2023 to 2024 and 2022 to 2023, the National Insurance contributions rates for directors are different. Read CA44 to find out more about [rates for directors](https://www.gov.uk/government/publications/ca44-national-insurance-for-company-directors) (<https://www.gov.uk/government/publications/ca44-national-insurance-for-company-directors>).

3. Class 2 and Class 4 National Insurance (self-employed)

There are 2 types of National Insurance for people who work for themselves (<https://www.gov.uk/working-for-yourself>), depending on their profits.

3.1 Class 2

Thresholds	2026 to 2027	2025 to 2026	2024 to 2025	2023 to 2024
Small Profits Threshold amount per year	£7,105	£6,845	£6,725	£6,725
Rate per week	£3.65	£3.50	£3.45	£3.45

3.2 Class 4

£ per year	2026 to 2027	2025 to 2026	2024 to 2025	2023 to 2024
Lower Profits Limit Self-employed people pay Class 4 National Insurance on profits above the Lower Profits Limit	£12,570	£12,570	£12,570	£12,570
Upper Profits Limit Self-employed people pay a lower rate of Class 4 National Insurance on profits above the Upper Profits Limit	£50,270	£50,270	£50,270	£50,270
Rate between Lower Profits Limit to the Upper Profits Limit	6%	6%	6%	9%
Rate above Upper Profits Limit	2%	2%	2%	2%

3.3 Special rates

£ per week	2026 to 2027	2025 to 2026	2024 to 2025	2023 to 2024
Special Class 2 rate for <u>share fishermen</u>	£4.30	£4.15	£4.10	£4.10
Special Class 2 rate for <u>volunteer development workers</u>	£6.45	£6.25	£6.15	£6.15
Additional Class 4 rate when <u>deferring National Insurance</u>	2%	2%	2%	2%

4. Class 3 National Insurance (voluntary)

You can pay voluntary National Insurance (<https://www.gov.uk/voluntary-national-insurance-contributions>) to fill or avoid gaps in your record.

If you're paying voluntary contributions for the previous 2 tax years (2023 to 2024 or 2022 to 2023), you'll pay the original rates for those years.

For all other years you'll pay the current rate (2024 to 2025).

£ per week	2026 to 2027	2025 to 2026	2024 to 2025	2023 to 2024
Class 3 rate	£18.40	£17.75	£17.45	£17.45

Monthly Direct Debit payments for 2026 to 2027

How much you pay depends on whether there are 4 or 5 weeks in the month.

Payment date	Amount
8 May 2026	£73.60
12 June 2026	£73.60
10 July 2026	£92.00
14 August 2026	£73.60
11 September 2026	£73.60
9 October 2026	£92.00
13 November 2026	£73.60
11 December 2026	£73.60
8 January 2027	£92.00
12 February 2027	£73.60
12 March 2027	£73.60
9 April 2027	£92.00

5. Historical and future rates

You can view [National Insurance rates and thresholds for previous tax years](https://www.gov.uk/government/statistics/main-features-of-national-insurance-contributions) (<https://www.gov.uk/government/statistics/main-features-of-national-insurance-contributions>).

There will be some [new National Insurance rates and thresholds](https://www.gov.uk/guidance/rates-and-thresholds-for-employers-2026-to-2027) (<https://www.gov.uk/guidance/rates-and-thresholds-for-employers-2026-to-2027>) from 6 April 2026.

6. Income Tax rates

You can see [Income Tax rates](https://www.gov.uk/income-tax-rates) (<https://www.gov.uk/income-tax-rates>) for the current and previous tax years.



All content is available under the [Open Government Licence v3.0](#), except where otherwise stated



© Crown copyright